



How to use SkillGap Assess

SkillGap Assess helps students find out how ready they are for an internship. You rate your own skills, and the app shows you which ones are strong, which ones need work, and what to study next. This guide walks you through it from the very beginning.

● <https://skill-gap-two.vercel.app>

Type that address into any web browser — Chrome, Edge or Safari — on a computer, tablet or phone. There is nothing to download or install.

First, which kind of account do you have?

There are two kinds, and each one sees a completely different part of the app. An account is **either** one **or** the other — never both. That is why there is no button to switch between them. Find yourself below, then read that section.

Student

You want to check your own internship readiness. You create your own account, and you only ever see your own results.

Read the green section below.

Administrator

You are staff. You decide which skills are measured, what counts as a good score, and what advice students receive. You can see everyone's results.

Read the purple section below.

Not sure which you are? If nobody has given you a username and password, you are a student — go ahead and create your own account.

For students

Six steps, from creating an account to reading your results.

1 Create your account

Open the website. In the top-right corner, click the **Get started free** button.

You will be asked for a few details across two short screens: first your name, email address, and a password you choose, then a little about your studies so staff can group you with students on similar courses.

Your password needs to be at least 8 characters long.

Your full name

Email address

Password (8+ characters)

Your university

Your course

Which year you are in

Each email address can only be used once. If the app says an account with that email already exists, you have signed up before — skip to step 2 and log in instead.

2 Log in

Click **Log in** at the top of the page, type your email address and password, then click the blue **Sign in** button.

You will arrive at your **dashboard** — your personal home page in the app. You can get back to it at any time by clicking **Dashboard** at the top of the page.

There is a tick box called **Keep me signed in**. Tick it on your own laptop or phone and you will stay logged in for 30 days. Leave it unticked on a shared or library computer — you will then be logged out after 12 hours, which is safer.

3 Rate your skills

On your dashboard, click **Start assessment**. You will see a list of skills. For each one, say how good you think you are: **Very Good**, **Good**, **Average** or **Poor**. There is also a **Skip** option.

At the end there are two questions to answer in your own words: what kind of internship you are hoping for, and what you find hardest at the moment. A sentence or two is plenty.

Skipping is completely safe. If you have never used a skill and genuinely cannot judge it, choose Skip. The app leaves it out altogether — it does *not* count it as zero and it will not pull your results down. Skipping is better than guessing.

4 You can stop and finish later

Click **Save draft** at any point. Your answers are kept, but nothing is worked out yet. You can close the page, shut your laptop, come back next week, and everything you typed will still be there waiting for you.

5 Send it in

When you have finished, click **Submit assessment**. You need to have rated at least one skill. Your results appear straight away.

Once you submit, that set of answers is locked and cannot be edited. That is on purpose — it keeps a fair record of how you were doing at the time. When you have improved and want a fresh picture, simply do a new assessment. Your dashboard always shows your most recent one.

6 Read your results

At the top you will see your **internship readiness** as a percentage — roughly, how close your scores are to what employers expect. Underneath is a count of how many skills are doing well and how many need work.

Then comes a chart comparing your score on each skill against the target score, and a list of your skills with the most urgent ones first. Each one is coloured red, amber or green. The table further down explains exactly what those colours mean.

Last are your **recommendations** — courses, articles or videos your university has chosen for the skills you are weakest at — and a **focus plan** telling you where to start. Click **Download PDF report** to save it all as a file you can email to a tutor or careers adviser.

If you see “**Needs admin review**”, it simply means staff have not added any study material for that skill yet. There is nothing wrong with your account. Click **Refresh recommendations** once they have.

For administrators

Administrator accounts cannot be created from the website — whoever set the system up creates them for you. The system comes with one ready-made admin account.

1 Log in

Use the same **Log in** page as students; there is no separate staff address. The app recognises your account and takes you to the admin area automatically.

The account the system comes with is:

admin@university.edu

Admin123!

Please change this password before real students start using the system. It is written down in the system's setup files, so anyone with a copy of them can read it.

2 Choose which skills are measured

Click **Skills** in the menu on the left. Whatever you list here is exactly what students are asked to rate. Nothing is fixed in advance — if a skill is not on this list, nobody will be asked about it.

3 Set the target for each skill

Click **Benchmarks**. For every skill, enter the score you would expect from someone ready for an internship, out of 100. The app compares each student against this number, and the difference is what it calls their gap.

If a skill has no target, the app cannot work out a gap for it, so it quietly disappears from student results. Give every skill that matters a target.

4 Add the study material

Click **Rules**. Here you link a course, article or video to a skill, and say how far behind a student has to be before they are shown it. That way a small weakness and a serious one can point to different material.

5 Decide what counts as good and bad

Click **Severity settings**. These two numbers set where red, amber and green begin and end for everybody. Change them and every student's results are re-coloured automatically next time they look — you do not need to ask anyone to redo their assessment.

6 See how everyone is doing

Click **Cohort** for the whole picture: average scores, which skills most students struggle with, how many have taken part, and common themes from their written answers. From there you can click any individual student to see their full results.

Where the numbers come from

Worth reading whoever you are — this explains every figure and colour in the app.

What each answer is worth

YOU CHOOSE	WORTH	WHAT HAPPENS
Very Good	100	Counted
Good	75	Counted
Average	50	Counted
Poor	25	Counted — even the lowest answer is well above zero
Skip	—	Ignored completely. Never counts against you.

What the colours mean

Take the target score for a skill, subtract your score, and what is left is the gap. The bigger the gap, the more attention that skill needs. The numbers below are the usual settings — your university can change them.

COLOUR	HOW FAR BELOW TARGET	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
 Green	0 – 10	You are where you need to be. Nothing to do.
 Amber	10 – 25	A little short. Worth some practice.
 Red	more than 25	A long way short. Start with these.

Words you will see in the app

WORD	WHAT IT ACTUALLY MEANS
Dashboard	Your personal home page inside the app.
Assessment	The set of questions where you rate your own skills.
Draft	A half-finished assessment, saved but not yet sent in.
Benchmark	The score employers expect for a skill. Your target.
Gap	How far your score sits below that target.
Severity	How serious a gap is, shown as red, amber or green.
Cohort	All the students using the system, looked at together.
Focus plan	A short summary of what to work on first.

If something does not look right

– I have logged in but I cannot find the staff pages

Your account is a student account, and students cannot open the staff area — the app sends you back to your own dashboard. If you need staff access, ask whoever looks after the system to set you up with an administrator account.

– I am staff and it keeps sending me away from the student dashboard

That is meant to happen. Administrator accounts do not take assessments, so the app takes you to the admin area instead. To see what a student sees, open the **Cohort** page and click their name.

– I was logged out on my own

You are logged out after 12 hours, unless you ticked **Keep me signed in**, which keeps you signed in for 30 days. Just log in again — nothing is lost, and a saved draft will still be there.

- **I have forgotten my password**

There is no “forgot password” link at the moment. Contact whoever looks after the system and they can set a new password for you.

- **My dashboard says I have not done an assessment yet**

Saving a draft is not the same as sending it in. Open your assessment again and click **Submit assessment** at the bottom. Your results will then appear.

- **The assessment page says there are no skills**

Staff have not added any skills yet, so there is nothing to rate. There is nothing wrong with your account and nothing for you to do — check back once they have set it up.

- **My results look out of date**

Your dashboard always shows your most recent completed assessment. If staff have changed the targets or added new study material since you finished, click **Refresh recommendations** to bring your advice up to date.

SkillGap Assess — check how ready you are for an internship, see which skills need work, and get advice on what to study next. Sign in at skill-gap-two.vercel.app.